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Remotely Query Secured Data

Abstract

A request is received at an assistant computing device over a network from a requesting computing device to query a dataset located on a remote computing device. The remote computing device resides in a secured data center. Encrypted access credentials are communicated to the requesting computing device. The encrypted access credentials are configured to allow the requesting computing device to access the remote computing device. At least one set of encrypted results are received from the requesting computing device. The encrypted results are decrypted to obtain results. The results are communicated to the requesting computing device.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/540,107, filed Dec. 14, 2023, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/379,842, filed Jul. 19, 2021, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/508,451, filed Jul. 11, 2019, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/097,577, filed Apr. 13, 2016, which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/149,541, filed Apr. 18, 2015, which are all hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety.

BACKGROUND

[0002] Data security is an important issue. There is a need to enable users to securely and remotely query and process data that is sitting inside a secure network.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWINGS

[0003] FIG. 1 is an example block diagram showing a system for remotely accessing data on a remote secured server according to some of the various embodiments of the present invention.

[0004] FIG. 2 is another example block diagram showing a system for remotely accessing data on a remote secured server according to some of the various embodiments of the present invention.

[0005] FIG. 3 is another example block diagram showing a system for remotely accessing data on a remote secured server according to some of the various embodiments of the present invention.

[0006] FIG. 4 is example block diagram showing communication flow between components in a system for remotely accessing data on a remote secured server according to some of the various embodiments of the present invention.

[0007] FIG. 5 is an example flow diagram illustrating remote access of secured data from the perspective of a requesting computing device according to some of the various embodiments of the present invention.

[0008] FIG. 6 is an example flow diagram illustrating remote access of secured data from the perspective of an assistant computing device according to some of the various embodiments of the present invention.

[0009] FIG. 7 is an example flow diagram illustrating remote access of secured data from the perspective of a remote computing device according to some of the various embodiments of the present invention.

[0010] FIG. 8 illustrates an example of a suitable computing system environment on which aspects of some embodiments may be implemented.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

[0011] Some of the various embodiments of the present invention relate to remotely accessing data

on a secured server. According to some of the various embodiments, SaaS (Software as A Service) tools may securely query and process data that is sitting inside a secure network by using a user workstation as a bridge to pass instructions to a secured data server and receiving the results for further processing and reporting. In this way, embodiments may provide security and scalability of enterprise tools to the SaaS based tools. A volume data comprising the data may remain in the host environment and processing of data done on the host environment. This may enable higher security of data. Since the processing occurs on the host environment, the latency of data may be low. Scalability may be increased since the SaaS data tools do not need the same storage and computing capacity as the host environment. This may allow some of the various embodiments to provide high service levels to the end user.

[0012] Some of the various embodiments may enable businesses to leverage new technologies and solutions that are owned and operated by third parties to work directly with their enterprise data in a secure fashion and the without the need to install these applications in their own network or by providing direct access to data to these applications.

[0013] FIG. 1 is an example block diagram showing a system **100** for remotely accessing data **145** on a remote secured server **140** according to some of the various embodiments of the present invention. As illustrated in this example system, an assistant computing device **100** assists a requesting computing device **120** to access a data set **145** via a remote computing device **140** over a network **160**. In this alternative embodiment, requesting computing device **120** and assistant computing device **110** may reside outside of physically secured data center **150**. Remote computing device **140** may reside inside physically secured data center **150**. Assistant computing device **110** may communicate to requesting computing device **120** through network **160** via communication links **122** and **112**. Assistant computing device **110** may communicate to remote computing device **140** through network **160** and firewall **130** via communication links **112**, **132** and **152**. Requesting computing device may communicate to remote computing device **140** through network **160** and firewall **130** via communication links **122**, **132** and **152**.

[0014] The remote computing device **140** may comprise a computing device such as, but not limited to: a personal computing device (PC, tablet or phone), a distributed computing device (e.g. a server) that comprises the data which the requester is trying to query and analyze, a combination thereof, and/or the like. According to some of the various embodiments, the remote computing device **140** could be the same as the requesting computing device **120** (when the dataset **145** is located on the same device) but more often than not, the remote computing device **140** and requesting computing device **120** are separate devices. The remote computing device may serve data remotely by receiving and processing queries received. (An example of a typical query format is Sequential Query Language (SQL)).

[0015] According to some of the various embodiments, the remote computing device **140** may reside in a physically secured data center **150**. The term “data center,” as applied herein may to specially designed computer rooms. A data center may comprise a facility used to house computer systems and associated components, such as telecommunications and storage systems. Data center(s) generally includes redundant or backup power supplies, redundant data communications connections, environmental controls (e.g., air conditioning, fire suppression) and various security devices. Communications in data centers may be based on networks running, for example, an IP protocol suite. Data centers may comprise a set of routers and switches that transport traffic between the servers and to the outside world. Redundancy of the Internet connection may be provided by using two or more upstream service providers. Some of the servers at the data center may be employed for running the basic Internet and intranet services needed by internal users in the organization, e.g., e-mail servers, proxy servers, and DNS servers. Network security elements may also be deployed. Examples of network security elements may comprise, but are not limited to: firewalls, VPN gateways, intrusion detection systems, combinations thereof, and/or the like. Also common are monitoring systems for the network and some of the applications. Additional off site

monitoring systems are also typical, in case of a failure of communications inside the data center. [0016] The data center **150** may be secured. For example, physical access to the site may be restricted to selected personnel, with controls such as, for example, a layered security system. A layered security system may comprise elements such as fencing, bollards and mantraps. Video camera surveillance and permanent security guards may be present.

[0017] A mantrap, may comprise a physical security access control system comprising a small space with two sets of interlocking doors, such that the first set of doors must close before the second set opens. In a manual mantrap, a guard may lock and unlock each door in sequence. An intercom and/or video camera may be employed to allow the guard to control the trap from a remote location. In an automatic mantrap, identification may be required for each door, sometimes even possibly different measures for each door. For example, a key may open the first door, but a personal identification number entered on a number pad opens the second. Other methods of opening doors include proximity cards or biometric devices such as fingerprint readers, facial recognition systems, iris recognition scans, combinations thereof, and/or the like. Metal detectors may be built in, in order to prevent entrance of people carrying weapons.

[0018] According to some of the various embodiments, the physically secure data center **150** may comprise a physical facility that is owned or leased. The physically secure data center **150** may house the remote computing device **140** and/or the dataset **145** being accessed. The physical facility could be the same location where the requesting computing device **120** is located or could be located in a different place. The dataset **145** may be located in remote computing device **140** and be accessible by the requesting computing device **120** using access credentials. The access credentials may according to some embodiments, be optional.

[0019] According to some of the various embodiments, the remote computing device **140** may be in communication with a data set **145**. A data set **145** (or data set**145**) may comprise a collection of data. The collection of data may correspond to contents of database(s). Examples of databases comprise, but are not limited to: a relational database data set; (e.g. Oracle, DB2, Access); a non-relational database data set; (e.g. NOSQL); a web service query responsive data set; (e.g. Salesforce.com); an application specific query responsive data set; (e.g. SAP); a comma-separated-values (CSV) data set; a spreadsheet data set; (e.g. Microsoft Excel); a plain text data set; hierarchical format database(s); propriety format(s) (example Microsoft Excel); combinations thereof, and/or the like. According to some embodiments, a data set **145** may correspond to the contents of a statistical data matrix. The data set **145** may comprise value(s) for variable(s). Each value may be referred to as a datum. The data set **145** may comprise data for one or more members. According to some of the various embodiments, the term data set **145** may refer to the data in a collection of closely related tables, corresponding to a particular experiment or event. The data set **145** may be located, for example, on a network accessible drive, within the remote computing device **140**, or other location with communication of the remote computing device **140**.

[0020] The remote computing device by its definition can serve the data remotely by receiving and processing queries received. (example of typical query format is Sequential Query Language (SQL))

[0021] The data set **145** may be stored on a data storage device. A data storage device may comprise a device for recording and/or storing information (data). Examples of data storage devices comprise, but are not limited to: tangible storage mediums, Read-only memory, Random Access memories, flash drives, disk drives, network accessible drives, magnetic tape, optical drives, combinations thereof, and/or the like.

[0022] According to some of the various embodiments, the remote computing device **140** may be configured to communicate with an external network through a firewall. A firewall may comprise a network security system that controls incoming and outgoing network traffic based on an applied rule set. A firewall may establish a barrier between a trusted, secure internal network and another network (e.g., the Internet) that is assumed not to be secure and trusted. Firewalls may exist both as

software to run on general purpose hardware and as a hardware appliance. Many firewalls may also offer other functionality to the internal network they protect, such as acting as a DHCP server for that network. Some firewalls may be implemented as software in combination with hardware and/or virtual. According to some of the various embodiments, the firewall may comprise a routing function abilities that pass data between networks and components.

[0023] A security Appliance may comprise a network security system that controls the incoming and outgoing network traffic based on an applied rule set. The appliance may establish a barrier between a trusted, secure internal network and another network (e.g., the Internet) that is assumed not to be secure and trusted. The security appliance may exist as a hardware appliance, software appliance or software program. An example of security appliance is a firewall.

[0024] Requesting computing device **120** may comprise a computing device configured to initiate a request such as, but not limited to: a personal computing device (e.g. PC, Tablet, and Phone), a distributed computing device (server), combinations thereof, and/or the like. The first step in the flow of information may be initiated by the requesting computing device **120**. During the time of this request, the requesting computing device **120** may be located within a company's internal network or have access to a company's network (For example, over a virtual private network (VPN)).

[0025] According to some of the various embodiments, a request may be initiated on a requesting computing device **120** by a requester. A requester may, for example without limitation, comprise a human user or a machine program that initiates the request for information. A human user may initiate a request when he or she needs the information. The machine program may comprise, for example, a monitoring program that may be configures to initiate a request for information based on the occurrence of an event. The event could, for example, be the passage of time or could be a trigger event that occurs. For example, a trigger event could be the arrival of a new data file or completion of a batch schedule.

[0026] According to some of the various embodiments, a request may employ, for example without limitation, hypertext transfer protocol. (HTTP or HTTPS). The request may, for example, be specifically related to data that exists on the remote computing device **140**. The request may be configured, for example, to query data (read-only), manipulate data. (write), combinations thereof, and/or the like. Examples of requests may comprise without limitation: 1) run an audit on a date of birth field of a people dataset; 2) profile columns of a people dataset; 3) if the date of birth format is mm-dd-yyyy, then convert to mm/dd/yyyy; 4) retrieve sales by quarter; combinations thereof, and/or the like.

[0027] According to some of the various embodiments, a requesting computing device **120** may be configured to employ credentials to communicate remote instructions to the remote computing device **140** over an external network **160** and through firewall **130**. Credentials may comprise, for example access credentials. Access credentials may comprise a set of information required to connect and query the remote computing device **140**. The information may comprise, for example, one or more of remote server address(es), port number(s), database or application instance name(s), database schema name(s), login(s), password(s), file path name(s), combinations thereof, and/or the like.

[0028] According to some of the various embodiments, a requesting computing device **120** may be configured to receive query results from the remote computing device **140**. The query results may be generated by the remote computing device **140** executing remote instructions. Query Results may comprise data received back from the remote computing device **140** as a result of processing query instruction(s). Data received back may comprise, for example, a single value, a result set which consists of a set of rows from a database, metadata comprising the name of the column of data, combinations thereof, and/or the like. For data manipulation queries, the result returned may comprise, for example, metadata representing the success or failure of an operation. For example, the result returned may comprise a number of rows updated.

[0029] The requesting computing device **120** may be configured to convert the query results into a Flexible Data Representation (FDR) format. A Flexible Data Representation (FDR) may comprise a language independent format that employs human-readable text to transmit data objects as attribute-value pairs. An FDR may be employed to transmit query results between requesting computing device(s) **120** and assistant computing device(s) **110**. The format may enable transmitting data in a byte-optimized format configured to support attributes or columns of data and various number of records.

[0030] According to some of the various embodiments, an assistant computing device **110** may be a distributed computing device configured to handle requests from requesting computing device(s), process and analyze the request(s), co-ordinate the flow of information; provide answers to a requester, combinations thereof, and/or the like. Assistant computing device **110** may comprise a server, a personal computer, an embedded system, combinations thereof, and/or the like.

[0031] According to some of the various embodiments, an assistant computing device **110** may be configured to receive a request from the requesting computing device **120** to query the data set **145**. The request may be configured to identify the remote computing device **140**. The assistant computing device **110** may be configured to communicate with the requesting computing device **120** via various mechanisms such as, but not limited to: an external network (e.g. Internet), an internal network, a wide area network WAN, a Local Area Network LAN, a virtual private network (VPN), a combination thereof, and/or the like.

[0032] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **110** may be configured to identify the access credential requirements to allow the requesting computing device **120** to access the remote computing device **140**.

[0033] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **110** may be configured to generate access credentials, employing at least in part, the access credential requirements.

[0034] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **110** may be configured to identify remote processing requirements for the remote computing device **150** to access the data set **145** identified in the request. The assistant computing device **110** may be further configured to generate remote processing instructions, employing at least in part, the remote processing requirements, the remote processing instructions may be configured to be executable by the remote computing device to satisfy the request; (few flow diagrams may be useful). Remote processing instructions may comprise data processing instruction set(s) specific to the data source in the remote computing device **140** that may be employed to process and retrieve data **145**.

Example of instructions in the data processing instruction may comprise, for example, retrieving data (e.g. querying and selecting), manipulating data (e.g. writing data like Add, Delete, and Update), combinations thereof, and/or the like. Example of a remote instruction may comprise: 1) for a direct database query: SELECT COUNT(*) FROM EMPLOYEES; 2) for an SAP application: Call Function Module Z_ABC and send parameters; 3) for a web application: Call Web Service Method getEmployees passing the filter criteria; and/or the like.

[0035] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **110** may be configured to encrypt the access credentials to generate encrypted access credentials. Similarly, the assistant computing device **110** may be configured to encrypt the remote processing instructions to generate encrypted remote processing instructions. Encryption may convert the access credentials and/or remote processing instructions into non-readable text by applying a cryptographic algorithm. Examples of crypto algorithm are RSA, SHA-1, SHA-2 with 64, 128 or 256 bits of encryption.

[0036] A cipher may be employed to perform encryption and decryption. A cipher may comprise a pair of algorithms that create the encryption and the reversing decryption. Ciphers may be categorized as symmetric key algorithms and asymmetric key algorithms. Examples of ciphers comprise, but are not limited to: AES_128 (a private key algorithm) and ECDHE_RSA (a public key algorithm).

[0037] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **110** may be configured to employ the encrypted access credentials to electronically communicate the encrypted remote processing instructions to the requesting computing device. The encrypted access credentials may be configured to include at least one of the following: remote login instructions; remote computing device information name; remote computing device login password; remote computing device port number; remote computing device data store name; remote computing device login name; physically secured data center information name; physically secured data center access password; physically secured data center port number; physically secured data center login name; a cryptographic key, a combination thereof, and/or the like.

[0038] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **110** may be configured to receive at least one set of encrypted results from the requesting computing device. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **110** may be configured to decrypt the encrypted results to obtain results.

[0039] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **110** may be configured to generate a report of results.

[0040] The report may comprise a presentation of quantitative and qualitative information to a user based on factual data, interpreted data, user input, combinations thereof, and/or the like. For example, a report on the result of a data quality audit to validate date of birth in mm/dd/yyyy format could comprise: quantitative information like total number of records processed, total number of records failing the audit and the detailed records themselves; qualitative information like whether the audit passed the audit threshold, trend information based on reconciling data with history, any system generated or user input comments; combinations thereof, and/or the like.

[0041] The report may further comprise additional information, the additional information comprising at least one of the following: logic; trending information; template information; intelligence information; benchmark information; data quality information; decision support information; data analysis information; combinations thereof, and/or the like. Additionally, the report may be configured to be accessed via a browser. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **110** may be configured to communicate the report to the requesting computing device through network **160** via communication links **112** and **122**.

[0042] FIG. **2** is another example block diagram showing a system **200** for remotely accessing data from a dataset **245** on a remote secured server **240** according to some of the various embodiments of the present invention. This alternative embodiment illustrates assistant computing device **210** communicating with requesting computing device **220** via link **212** outside of network **260**.

Example embodiments of the invention as illustrated in FIG. **2** are described with reference to the accompanying drawings, wherein like parts are designated by like reference numerals to FIG. **1** throughout. So for example, the decryption with respect to remote computing device **140** may also be applicable to remote computing device **240**.

[0043] The remote computing device **240** may comprise a computing device such as, but not limited to: a personal computing device (PC, tablet or phone), a distributed computing device (e.g. a server) that comprises the data which the requester is trying to query and analyze, a combination thereof, and/or the like. According to some of the various embodiments, the remote computing device may serve data remotely by receiving and processing received queries. (An example of a typical query format is Sequential Query Language (SQL)).

[0044] According to some of the various embodiments, the remote computing device **240** may reside in a physically secured data center **250**. According to some of the various embodiments, the physically secure data center **250** may comprise a physical facility that is owned or leased. The physically secure data center **250** may house the remote computing device **240** and/or the dataset **245** being accessed. The physical facility could be the same location where the requesting computing device **220** is located or could be located in a different place. The dataset **245** may be located in remote computing device **240** and be accessible by the requesting computing device **220**

using access credentials. The access credentials may according to some embodiments, be optional.

[0045] According to some of the various embodiments, the remote computing device **240** may be in communication with a data set **245**. A data set **245** (or data set **245**) may comprise a collection of data. The collection of data may correspond to contents of database(s). The remote computing device may be configured to serve data remotely by receiving and processing received queries.

[0046] The data set **245** may be stored on a data storage device. According to some of the various embodiments, the remote computing device **240** may be configured to communicate with an external network **260** through a firewall **230** via communication links **252** and **232**.

[0047] Requesting computing device **220** may comprise a computing device configured to initiate a request such as, but not limited to: a personal computing device (e.g. PC, Tablet, and Phone), a distributed computing device (server), combinations thereof, and/or the like. The flow of information may be initiated by the requesting computing device **220**. As illustrated, requesting computing device is outside the physically secured data center **250** and may communicate to the physically secured data center **250** via links **222**, **232** and **252** through network **260** and firewall **230**.

[0048] According to some of the various embodiments, a request may be initiated on a requesting computing device **220** by a requester. According to some of the various embodiments, a requesting computing device **220** may be configured to employ credentials to communicate remote instructions to the remote computing device **240** over an external network **260** and through firewall **230** via communication links **222**, **232**, and **252**. Credentials may comprise, for example access credentials. Access credentials may comprise a set of information required to connect and query the remote computing device **240**.

[0049] According to some of the various embodiments, a requesting computing device **220** may be configured to receive query results from the remote computing device **240**. The query results may be generated by the remote computing device **240** executing remote instructions. Query Results may comprise data received back from the remote computing device **240** as a result of processing query instruction(s).

[0050] The requesting computing device **220** may be configured to convert the query results into a Flexible Data Representation (FDR) format. An FDR may be employed to transmit query results between requesting computing device(s) **220** and assistant computing device(s) **210** via communications link **212**.

[0051] According to some of the various embodiments, assistant computing device **210** may be a distributed computing device configured to handle requests from requesting computing device(s), process and analyze the request(s), co-ordinate the flow of information; provide answers to a requester, combinations thereof, and/or the like. Assistant computing device **210** may comprise a server, a personal computer, an embedded system, combinations thereof, and/or the like.

[0052] According to some of the various embodiments, an assistant computing device **210** may be configured to receive a request from the requesting computing device **220** via communications link **212** to query the data set **245**. The request may be configured to identify the remote computing device **240**. The assistant computing device **210** may be configured to communicate with the requesting computing device **220** via various mechanisms such as, but not limited to: an external network (e.g. Internet), an internal network, a wide area network WAN, a Local Area Network LAN, a virtual private network (VPN), a combination thereof, and/or the like.

[0053] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **210** may be configured to identify the access credential requirements to allow the requesting computing device **220** to access the remote computing device **240**. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **210** may be configured to generate access credentials, employing at least in part, the access credential requirements.

[0054] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **210** may be configured to identify remote processing requirements for the remote computing device **250** to

access the data set **245** identified in the request. The assistant computing device **210** may be further configured to generate remote processing instructions, employing at least in part, the remote processing requirements, the remote processing instructions may be configured to be executable by the remote computing device to satisfy the request; (few flow diagrams may be useful). Remote processing instructions may comprise data processing instruction set(s) specific to the data source in the remote computing device **240** that are employed to process and retrieve data **245**.

[0055] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **210** may be configured to encrypt the access credentials to generate encrypted access credentials. Similarly, the assistant computing device **210** may be configured to encrypt the remote processing instructions to generate encrypted remote processing instructions.

[0056] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **210** may be configured to employ the encrypted access credentials to electronically communicate the encrypted remote processing instructions to the requesting computing device. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **210** may be configured to receive at least one set of encrypted results from the requesting computing device. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **210** may be configured to decrypt the encrypted results to obtain results. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **210** may be configured to generate a report of results. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **210** may be configured to communicate the report to the requesting computing device **220** via link **212**.

[0057] FIG. **3** is another example block diagram showing a system **300** for remotely accessing data from a dataset **345** on a remote secured server **340** according to some of the various embodiments of the present invention. In this alternative embodiment, requesting computing device **320** and remote computing device **340** may reside inside physically secured data center **350**. Assistant computing device **310** may reside outside of physically secured data center **350**. Assistant computing device **310** may communicate to requesting computing device **320** through network **360** via communication links **322** and **312**. Assistant computing device **310** may communicate to remote computing device **340** through network **360** and firewall **330** via communication links **312**, **332** and **352**. Requesting computing device may communicate to remote computing device **340** through network **360** and firewall **330** via communication links **322**, **332** and **352**. Example embodiments of the invention as illustrated in FIG. **3** are described with reference to the accompanying drawings, wherein like parts are designated by like reference numerals to FIG. **1** and FIG. **2** throughout. So for example, the decryption with respect to remote computing device **140** may also be applicable to remote computing device **340**.

[0058] The remote computing device **340** may comprise a computing device such as, but not limited to: a personal computing device (PC, tablet or phone), a distributed computing device (e.g. a server) that comprises the data which the requester is trying to query and analyze, a combination thereof, and/or the like. According to some of the various embodiments, the remote computing device **340** could be the same as the requesting computing device **320** (when the dataset **345** is located on the same device) but more often than not, the remote computing device **340** and requesting computing device **320** may be separate devices. The remote computing device may serve data remotely by receiving and processing queries received. (An example of a typical query format is Sequential Query Language (SQL)).

[0059] According to some of the various embodiments, the remote computing device **340** may reside in a physically secured data center **350**. According to some of the various embodiments, the physically secure data center **350** may comprise a physical facility that is owned or leased. The physically secure data center **350** may house the remote computing device **340** and/or the dataset **345** being accessed. The physical facility could be the same location where the requesting computing device **320** is located or could be located in a different place. The dataset **345** may be located in remote computing device **340** and be accessible by the requesting computing device **320**

using access credentials. The access credentials may according to some embodiments, be optional.

[0060] According to some of the various embodiments, the remote computing device **340** may be in communication with a data set **345**. A data set **345** (or data set **345**) may comprise a collection of data. The collection of data may correspond to contents of database(s). The remote computing device may be configured to serve data remotely by receiving and processing received queries. The data set **345** may be stored on a data storage device. According to some of the various embodiments, the remote computing device **340** may be configured to communicate with an external network **360** through a firewall **330** via communication links **352** and **332**.

[0061] Requesting computing device **320** may comprise a computing device configured to initiate a request such as, but not limited to: a personal computing device (e.g. PC, Tablet, and Phone), a distributed computing device (server), combinations thereof, and/or the like. The flow of information may be initiated by the requesting computing device **320**. As illustrated, requesting computing device is physically located inside the physically secured data center **350** and may communicate to the remote computing device **340** via network **360** over communications link **322**, and through firewall **330** via communications links **332** and **352**.

[0062] According to some of the various embodiments, a request may be initiated on a requesting computing device **320** by a requester. According to some of the various embodiments, a requesting computing device **320** may be configured to employ credentials to communicate remote instructions to the remote computing device **340** over an external network **360** and through firewall **330** via communication links **322**, **332**, and **352**. Credentials may comprise, for example access credentials. Access credentials may comprise a set of information required to connect and query the remote computing device **340**.

[0063] According to some of the various embodiments, a requesting computing device **320** may be configured to receive query results from the remote computing device **340**. The query results may be generated by the remote computing device **340** executing remote instructions. Query Results may comprise data received back from the remote computing device **340** as a result of processing query instruction(s).

[0064] The requesting computing device **320** may be configured to convert the query results into a Flexible Data Representation (FDR) format. An FDR may be employed to transmit query results between requesting computing device(s) **320** and assistant computing device(s) **310** via communications link **312**.

[0065] According to some of the various embodiments, assistant computing device **310** may be a distributed computing device configured to handle requests from requesting computing device(s), process and analyze the request(s), co-ordinate the flow of information; provide answers to a requester, combinations thereof, and/or the like. Assistant computing device **310** may comprise a server, a personal computer, an embedded system, combinations thereof, and/or the like.

[0066] According to some of the various embodiments, an assistant computing device **310** may be configured to receive a request from the requesting computing device **320** via communications link **312** to query the data set **345**. The request may be configured to identify the remote computing device **340**. The assistant computing device **310** may be configured to communicate with the requesting computing device **320** via various mechanisms such as, but not limited to: an external network (e.g. Internet), an internal network, a wide area network WAN, a Local Area Network LAN, a virtual private network (VPN), a combination thereof, and/or the like.

[0067] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **310** may be configured to identify the access credential requirements to allow the requesting computing device **320** to access the remote computing device **340**. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **310** may be configured to generate access credentials, employing at least in part, the access credential requirements.

[0068] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **310** may be configured to identify remote processing requirements for the remote computing device **350** to

access the data set **345** identified in the request. The assistant computing device **310** may be further configured to generate remote processing instructions, employing at least in part, the remote processing requirements, the remote processing instructions may be configured to be executable by the remote computing device to satisfy the request; (few flow diagrams may be useful). Remote processing instructions may comprise data processing instruction set(s) specific to the data source in the remote computing device **340** that are employed to process and retrieve data **345**.

[0069] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **310** may be configured to encrypt the access credentials to generate encrypted access credentials. Similarly, the assistant computing device **310** may be configured to encrypt the remote processing instructions to generate encrypted remote processing instructions.

[0070] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **310** may be configured to employ the encrypted access credentials to electronically communicate the encrypted remote processing instructions to the requesting computing device. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **310** may be configured to receive at least one set of encrypted results from the requesting computing device. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **310** may be configured to decrypt the encrypted results to obtain results. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **310** may be configured to generate a report of results. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **310** may be configured to communicate the report to the requesting computing device **320** through network **360** via links **312** and **322**.

[0071] FIG. **4** is example block diagram showing communication flow between components in a system **400** for remotely accessing data **445** on a remote secured server **440** according to some of the various embodiments of the present invention.

[0072] According to some of the various embodiments, a request **450** may be made by a requesting computing device **420** to an assistant computing device **410** to query a dataset **445** in communication with a remote computing device **440**. The remote computing device **440** may reside in a physically secured data center and may not be directly accessible to the assistant computing device **410**.

[0073] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **410** may identify access credential requirements to allow the requesting computing device **420** to access the remote computing device **440** identified in the request **450**. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **410** may identify remote processing requirements for the remote computing device **440** to access the dataset **445** identified in the request **450**. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **410** may generate access credentials, employing at least in part, the access credential requirements. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **410** may generate remote processing instructions, employing at least in part, the remote processing requirements. The remote processing instructions may be configured to be executable by the remote computing device **440** to satisfy the request **450**. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **410** may encrypt the access credentials to generate encrypted access credentials **460**. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **410** may encrypt the remote processing instructions to generate encrypted remote processing instructions **470**.

[0074] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **410** may communicate the encrypted access credentials **460** to the requesting computing device **420**. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **410** may communicate the encrypted remote processing instructions **470** to the requesting computing device **420**. The encrypted access credentials **460** may be configured to allow the requesting computing device **420** to access the remote computing device **440**. The encrypted remote instructions **470** may comprise remote instructions configured to enable the remote computing device **440** to execute at least one of the following: at least one data query; and at least one data manipulation.

[0075] According to some of the various embodiments, the requesting computing device **420** may decrypt the encrypted access credentials **460** to obtain access credentials **465**. According to some of the various embodiments, requesting computing device **420** may decrypt the encrypted remote instructions **470** to obtain remote instructions **475**. The remote computing device **440** may be behind a firewall **430**. According to some of the various embodiments, requesting computing device **420** may access the remote computing device **440** using the access credentials **465**. According to some of the various embodiments, requesting computing device **420** may communicate the remote instructions **475** to the remote computing device **440**.

[0076] According to some of the various embodiments, the remote computing device **440** may reside in a physically secured data center and not be directly accessible to the assistant computing device **410**. According to some of the various embodiments, the remote computing device **440** may receive the remote instructions **475**. The remote instructions may comprise remote instructions configured to enable the remote computing device **440** to execute at least one of the following: (1) at least one data query; and (2) at least one data manipulation. According to some of the various embodiments, the remote computing device **440** may execute the remote instructions **475** to generate query results **480**. According to some of the various embodiments, the remote computing device **440** may communicate the query results **480** to the requesting device **420**. At least part of the query results may be configured to be employable by the assistant computing device **410** to generate a report **490**.

[0077] According to some of the various embodiments, the requesting computing device **420** may receive the query results. According to some of the various embodiments, the requesting computing device **420** may convert the query results **480** into a flexible data representation **485** of the query results **480**. The conversion may involve encrypting the query results **480**. According to some of the various embodiments, the requesting computing device **420** may communicate the flexible data representation **485** to the assistant computing device **410**.

[0078] According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **410** may receive the flexible data representation **485** from the requesting computing device **420**. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **410** may process the flexible data representation **485** to obtain the query results **480**. The processing may involve decrypting flexible data representation **485**. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **410** may generate a report of results **490** employing at least part of the query results **480**. According to some of the various embodiments, the assistant computing device **410** may communicate the report **490** to the requesting computing device **420**.

[0079] FIGS. **5**, **6** and **7** are example flow diagrams that together illustrate embodiments where a requesting computing device may access secured data from a remote computing device employing the assistance of an assistant computing device. Specifically, FIG. **5** illustrates remote access of secured data from the perspective of a requesting computing device, FIG. **6** illustrates remote access of secured data from the perspective of an assistant computing device, and FIG. **7** illustrates remote access of secured data from the perspective of a remote computing device. Additionally, FIGS. **5**, **6** and **7** are to be interpreted with respect to the descriptions of various embodiments above of the requesting computing device, remote computing device, the assistant computing device, and their interconnections.

[0080] FIG. **5** is an example flow diagram illustrating remote access of secured data from the perspective of a requesting computing device according to some of the various embodiments of the present invention.

[0081] According to some of the various embodiments, a request may be made from a requesting computing device to an assistant computing device to query a dataset in communication with a remote computing device at **510**. The remote computing device may reside in a physically secured data center. The remote computing device may not be directly accessible to the assistant computing device.

[0082] According to some of the various embodiments, encrypted access credentials and encrypted remote instructions may be received at the requesting computing device from the assistant computing device at **515**. The encrypted access credentials may be configured to allow the requesting computing device to access the remote computing device. The encrypted remote instructions may comprise remote instructions configured to enable the remote computing device to execute at least one of the following: at least one data query; and at least one data manipulation.

[0083] According to some of the various embodiments, the encrypted access credentials may be decrypted by the requesting computing device to obtain access credentials at **520**. Similarly, the encrypted remote instructions may be decrypted at the requesting computing device to obtain remote instructions at **525**.

[0084] According to some of the various embodiments, the requesting computing device may access the remote computing device using the access credentials at **530**. The remote instructions may be communicated from the requesting computing device to the remote computing device at **535**. Query results may be generated by the remote computing device executing the remote instructions.

[0085] According to some of the various embodiments, query results from the remote computing device may be received at the requesting computing device at **540**. The requesting computing device may generate encrypted query results by encrypting the query results at **545**. The encrypted query results may be communicated from the requesting computing device to the assistant computing device at **550**. At **555**, the requesting computing device may receive a report from the assistant computing device. The report may comprise, at least in part, a decrypted version of at least a part of the encrypted query results.

[0086] FIG. **6** is an example flow diagram illustrating remote access of secured data from the perspective of an assistant computing device according to some of the various embodiments of the present invention.

[0087] According to some of the various embodiments, a request may be receiving at an assistant computing device over a network from a requesting computing device to query a dataset located on a remote computing device at **610**. The remote computing device may reside in a physically secured data center. The remote computing device may not be directly accessible to the assistant computing device.

[0088] According to some of the various embodiments, access credential requirements may be identified to allow the requesting computing device to access the remote computing device identified in the request at **615**. Similarly, remote processing requirements may be identified for the remote computing device to access the dataset identified in the request at **620**.

[0089] According to some of the various embodiments, access credentials may be generated at **625** employing at least in part, the access credential requirements. Similarly, remote processing instructions may be generated at **630** employing at least in part, the remote processing requirements. The remote processing instructions may be configured to be executable by the remote computing device to satisfy the request.

[0090] According to some of the various embodiments, the access credentials may be encrypted at **635** to generate encrypted access credentials. Similarly, the remote processing instructions may be encrypted at **640** to generate encrypted remote processing instructions.

[0091] According to some of the various embodiment, the encrypted access credentials may be communicated to the requesting computing device at **640**. Similarly, the encrypted remote processing instructions may be communicated to the requesting computing device at **645**.

[0092] According to some of the various embodiments, at least one set of encrypted results may be received the requesting computing device at **650**. The encrypted results may be decrypted at **655** to obtain the results. A report of the results may be generated at **660**. The report may be communicated to the requesting computing device at **665**.

[0093] FIG. **7** is an example flow diagram illustrating remote access of secured data from the

perspective of a remote computing device according to some of the various embodiments of the present invention.

[0094] According to some of the various embodiments, remote instructions may be received at a remote computing device from a requesting device through a firewall at **710**. The remote computing device may reside in a physically secured data center and not be directly accessible to an assistant computing device. The receiving may be accomplished, at least in part, employing access credentials presented by the requesting device. The encrypted access credentials may be configured to allow the requesting computing device to access the remote computing device. The encrypted remote instructions may comprise remote instructions configured to enable the remote computing device to execute at least one of the following: at least one data query; and at least one data manipulation.

[0095] According to some of the various embodiments, the remote instructions and access credentials may have been formed by the requesting device as follows. The requesting device may have made a request to the assistant computing device to query a dataset in communication with the remote computing device. The requesting device may have received encrypted access credentials and encrypted remote instructions from the assistant computing device. The requesting device may have decrypted the encrypted access credentials to obtain access credentials. Similarly, the requesting device may have decrypted the encrypted remote instructions to obtain remote instructions.

[0096] According to some of the various embodiments, remote computing device may execute the remote instructions to generate query results at **720**. The query results may be communicated to the requesting device at **730**. At least part of the query results may be configured to be employable by the assistant computing device to generate a report.

[0097] FIG. **8** illustrates an example of a suitable computing system environment **800** on which aspects of some embodiments may be implemented. The computing system environment **800** is only one example of a suitable computing environment and is not intended to suggest any limitation as to the scope of use or functionality of the claimed subject matter. Neither should the computing environment **800** be interpreted as having any dependency or requirement relating to any one or combination of components illustrated in the exemplary operating environment **800**.

[0098] Embodiments are operational with numerous other general purpose or special purpose computing system environments or configurations. Examples of well-known computing systems, environments, and/or configurations that may be suitable for use with various embodiments include, but are not limited to, embedded computing systems, personal computers, server computers, hand-held or laptop devices, multiprocessor systems, microprocessor-based systems, set top boxes, programmable consumer electronics, network PCs, minicomputers, mainframe computers, cloud services, telephony systems, distributed computing environments that include any of the above systems or devices, and the like.

[0099] Embodiments may be described in the general context of computer-executable instructions, such as program modules, being executed by computing capable devices. Generally, program modules include routines, programs, objects, components, data structures, etc. that perform particular tasks or implement particular abstract data types. Some embodiments may be designed to be practiced in distributed computing environments where tasks may be performed by remote processing devices that are linked through a communications network. In a distributed computing environment, program modules may be located in both local and remote computer storage media including memory storage devices.

[0100] With reference to FIG. **8**, an example system for implementing some embodiments includes a computing device **810**. Components of computer **810** may include, but are not limited to, a processing unit **820**, a system memory **830**, and a system bus **821** that couples various system components including the system memory to the processing unit **820**.

[0101] Computer **810** typically includes a variety of computer readable media. Computer readable

media can be any available media that can be accessed by computer **810** and includes both volatile and nonvolatile media, and removable and non-removable media. By way of example, and not limitation, computer readable media may comprise computer storage media and communication media. Computer storage media includes both volatile and nonvolatile, and removable and non-removable media implemented in any method or technology for storage of information such as computer readable instructions, data structures, program modules or other data. Computer storage media includes, but is not limited to, random access memory (RAM), read-only memory (ROM), electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM), flash memory or other memory technology, compact disc read-only memory (CD-ROM), digital versatile disks (DVD) or other optical disk storage, magnetic cassettes, magnetic tape, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium which can be used to store the desired information and which can be accessed by computer **810**. Communication media typically embodies computer readable instructions, data structures, program modules or other data in a modulated data signal such as a carrier wave or other transport mechanism and includes any information delivery media. The term “modulated data signal” means a signal that has one or more of its characteristics set or changed in such a manner as to encode information in the signal. By way of example, and not limitation, communication media includes wired media such as a wired network or direct-wired connection, and wireless media such as acoustic, radio frequency (RF), infrared and other wireless media. Combinations of any of the above should also be included within the scope of computer readable media.

[0102] The system memory **830** includes computer storage media in the form of volatile and/or nonvolatile memory such as ROM **831** and RAM **832**. A basic input/output system **833** (BIOS), comprising the basic routines that help to transfer information between elements within computer **810**, such as during start-up, is typically stored in ROM **831**. RAM **832** typically comprises data and/or program modules that are immediately accessible to and/or presently being operated on by processing unit **820**. By way of example, and not limitation, FIG. **8** illustrates operating system **834**, application programs **835**, other program modules **836**, and program data **837**.

[0103] The computer **810** may also include other removable/non-removable volatile/nonvolatile computer storage media. By way of example only, FIG. **8** illustrates a hard disk drive **841** that reads from or writes to non-removable, nonvolatile magnetic media, a magnetic disk drive **851** that reads from or writes to a removable, nonvolatile magnetic disk **852**, a flash drive reader **857** that reads flash drive **858**, and an optical disk drive **855** that reads from or writes to a removable, nonvolatile optical disk **856** such as a CD ROM or other optical media. Other removable/non-removable, volatile/nonvolatile computer storage media that can be used in the exemplary operating environment include, but are not limited to, magnetic tape cassettes, flash memory cards, digital versatile disks, digital video tape, solid state RAM, solid state ROM, and the like. The hard disk drive **841** is typically connected to the system bus **821** through a non-removable memory interface such as interface **840**, and magnetic disk drive **851** and optical disk drive **855** are typically connected to the system bus **821** by a removable memory interface, such as interface **850**.

[0104] The drives and their associated computer storage media discussed above and illustrated in FIG. **8** provide storage of computer readable instructions, data structures, program modules and other data for the computer **810**. In FIG. **8**, for example, hard disk drive **841** is illustrated as storing operating system **844**, application programs **845**, program data **847**, and other program modules **846**. Additionally, for example, non-volatile memory may include instructions to, for example, discover and configure IT device(s); the creation of device neutral user interface command(s); combinations thereof, and/or the like.

[0105] A user may enter commands and information into the computer **810** through input devices such as a keyboard **862**, a microphone **863**, a camera **864**, and a pointing device **861**, such as a mouse, trackball or touch pad. These and other input devices are often connected to the processing unit **820** through a user input interface **860** that is coupled to the system bus, but may be connected

by other interface and bus structures, such as a parallel port, game port or a universal serial bus (USB). A monitor **891** or other type of display device may also be connected to the system bus **821** via an interface, such as a video interface **890**. Other devices, such as, for example, speakers **897** and printer **896** may be connected to the system via peripheral interface **895**.

[0106] The computer **810** is operated in a networked environment using logical connections to one or more remote computers, such as a remote computer **880**. The remote computer **880** may be a personal computer, a hand-held device, a server, a router, a network PC, a peer device or other common network node, and typically includes many or all of the elements described above relative to the computer **810**. The logical connections depicted in FIG. **8** include a local area network (LAN) **871** and a wide area network (WAN) **873**, but may also include other networks. Such networking environments are commonplace in offices, enterprise-wide computer networks, intranets and the Internet.

[0107] When used in a LAN networking environment, the computer **810** is connected to the LAN **871** through a network interface or adapter **870**. When used in a WAN networking environment, the computer **810** typically includes a modem **872** or other means for establishing communications over the WAN **873**, such as the Internet. The modem **872**, which may be internal or external, may be connected to the system bus **821** via the user input interface **860**, or other appropriate mechanism. The modem **872** may be wired or wireless. Examples of wireless devices may comprise, but are limited to: Wi-Fi and Bluetooth. In a networked environment, program modules depicted relative to the computer **810**, or portions thereof, may be stored in the remote memory storage device. By way of example, and not limitation, FIG. **8** illustrates remote application programs **885** as residing on remote computer **880**. It will be appreciated that the network connections shown are exemplary and other means of establishing a communications link between the computers may be used. Additionally, for example, LAN **871** and WAN **873** may provide a network interface to communicate with other distributed infrastructure management device(s); with IT device(s); with users remotely accessing the User Input Interface **860**; combinations thereof, and/or the like.

[0108] Although the subject matter has been described in language specific to structural features and/or methodological acts, it is to be understood that the subject matter defined in the appended claims is not necessarily limited to the specific features or acts described above. Rather, the specific features and acts described above are disclosed as example forms of implementing the claims.

[0109] In this specification, “a” and “an” and similar phrases are to be interpreted as “at least one” and “one or more.” References to “an” embodiment in this disclosure are not necessarily to the same embodiment.

[0110] Many of the elements described in the disclosed embodiments may be implemented as modules. A module is defined here as an isolatable element that performs a defined function and has a defined interface to other elements. The modules described in this disclosure may be implemented in hardware, a combination of hardware and software, firmware, wetware (i.e. hardware with a biological element) or a combination thereof, all of which are behaviorally equivalent. For example, modules may be implemented using computer hardware in combination with software routine(s) written in a computer language (Java, HTML, XML, PHP, Python, ActionScript, JavaScript, Ruby, Prolog, SQL, VBScript, Visual Basic, Perl, C, C++, Objective-C or the like). Additionally, it may be possible to implement modules using physical hardware that incorporates discrete or programmable analog, digital and/or quantum hardware. Examples of programmable hardware include: computers, microcontrollers, microprocessors, application-specific integrated circuits (ASICs), field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs), and complex programmable logic devices (CPLDs). Computers, microcontrollers and microprocessors are programmed using languages such as assembly, C, C++ or the like. FPGAs, ASICs and CPLDs are often programmed using hardware description languages (HDL) such as VHSIC hardware description language (VHDL) or Verilog that configure connections between internal hardware

modules with lesser functionality on a programmable device. Finally, it needs to be emphasized that the above mentioned technologies may be used in combination to achieve the result of a functional module.

[0111] Some embodiments may employ processing hardware. Processing hardware may include one or more processors, computer equipment, embedded systems, machines a combination thereof, and/or the like. The processing hardware may be configured to execute instructions. The instructions may be stored on a machine-readable medium. According to some embodiments, the machine-readable medium (e.g. automated data medium) may be a medium configured to store data in a machine-readable format that may be accessed by an automated sensing device. Examples of machine-readable media include: magnetic disks, cards, tapes, and drums, flash memory, memory cards, electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM), solid state drives, optical disks, barcodes, magnetic ink characters, a combination thereof, and/or the like.

[0112] While various embodiments have been described above, it should be understood that they have been presented by way of example, and not limitation. It will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) that various changes in form and detail can be made therein without departing from the spirit and scope. In fact, after reading the above description, it will be apparent to one skilled in the relevant art(s) how to implement alternative embodiments. Thus, the present embodiments should not be limited by any of the above described exemplary embodiments. In particular, it should be noted that, for example purposes, the presently described embodiments are discussed with respect to a data center. However, one skilled in the art will recognize that embodiments may be employed to other collections of IT devices over, for example, a distributed network not confined by a single data center, a small collection of IT devices in an Intranet, combinations thereof, and/or the like.

[0113] In addition, it should be understood that any figures that highlight any functionality and/or advantages, are presented for example purposes only. The disclosed architecture is sufficiently flexible and configurable, such that it may be utilized in ways other than that shown. For example, the steps listed in any flowchart may be re-ordered or only optionally used in some embodiments.

[0114] Further, the purpose of the Abstract of the Disclosure is to enable the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office and the public generally, and especially the scientists, engineers and practitioners in the art who are not familiar with patent or legal terms or phraseology, to determine quickly from a cursory inspection the nature and essence of the technical disclosure of the application. The Abstract of the Disclosure is not intended to be limiting as to the scope in any way.

[0115] Finally, it is the applicant's intent that only claims that include the express language “means for” or “step for” be interpreted under 35 U.S.C. 112. Claims that do not expressly include the phrase “means for” or “step for” are not to be interpreted under 35 U.S.C. 112.

Claims

1. A process comprising: a) receiving a request at an assistant computing device over a network from a requesting computing device to query a dataset located on a remote computing device, the remote computing device residing in a secured data center; b) communicating encrypted access credentials to the requesting computing device, the encrypted access credentials configured to allow the requesting computing device to access the remote computing device; c) receiving at least one set of encrypted results from the requesting computing device; d) decrypting the encrypted results to obtain results; and e) communicating the results to the requesting computing device.
2. The process according to claim 1, wherein the encrypted results are in a Flexible Data Representation (FDR) format.
3. The process according to claim 1, wherein the requesting computing device and the assistant computing device are configured to communicate via an external network.
4. The process according to claim 1, wherein the requesting computing device and the assistant

- computing device are configured to communicate via a wide area network (WAN).
5. The process according to claim 1, wherein the requesting computing device and the assistant computing device are configured to communicate via a virtual private network (VPN) connection.
 6. The process according to claim 1, wherein at least one of the assistant computing device and the remote computing device comprises a server.
 7. The process according to claim 1, wherein the remote computing device is only electronically accessible through a firewall.
 8. The process according to claim 1, wherein the remote computing device is only electronically accessible through a security appliance.
 9. The process according to claim 1, further comprising downloading interface instructions.
 10. The process according to claim 1, further comprising downloading a software appliance.
 11. The process according to claim 1, wherein the secured data center is only electronically accessible through a firewall.
 12. The process according to claim 1, wherein the secured data center is only electronically accessible through a security appliance.
 13. The process according to claim 1, wherein the encrypted access credentials are further configured to comprise at least one of the following: a) remote login instructions; b) remote computing device information name; c) remote computing device login password; d) remote computing device port number; e) remote computing device data store name; f) remote computing device login name; g) secured data center information name; h) secured data center access password; i) secured data center port number; j) secured data center login name; or k) a cryptographic key.
 14. The process according to claim 1, wherein the dataset comprises at least one of the following: a) a relational database dataset; b) a non-relational database dataset; c) a web service query responsive dataset; d) an application specific query responsive dataset; e) a comma-separated-values (CSV) dataset; f) a spreadsheet dataset; or g) a plain text dataset.
 15. The process according to claim 1, wherein the dataset is located, at least in part, on a network accessible drive.
 16. The process according to claim 1, wherein the dataset is located, at least in part, within the remote computing device.
 17. The process according to claim 1, further comprising employing at least one of the following when decrypting the encrypted results: a) a symmetric cypher; or b) an asymmetric cypher.
 18. The process according to claim 1, further comprising converting the query results into a Flexible Data Representation (FDR) format.
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